VS

Vaishakh Surendran

HOTEL OWNER ADVISOR


CONTACT

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Veritas Hospitality Advisors


CORE EXPERTISE

- Hotel Owner Advisory
- Commercial Performance Review
- Revenue & Yield Management
- Operational Governance
- Owner Reporting & Oversight
- Pre-Opening & Brand Audits
- Team Leadership (300+ staff)
- Sustainability & IGBC

# Vaishakh Surendran

FOUNDER, VERITAS HOSPITALITY ADVISORS · HOTEL OWNER ADVISOR

> Hotelier with 25+ years of operational leadership across India, the Maldives, Kuwait and the United States — including General Manager roles since 2015 under Accor, Wyndham, ITC and independent flags. Founder of Veritas Hospitality Advisors: India's dedicated hotel owner advisory practice, working exclusively on the owner's side of the table.

## ADVISORY PRACTICE

### Founder & Principal Advisor

2024 – Present

Veritas Hospitality Advisors · Pan-India

- Independent hotel owner advisory — working exclusively for hotel owners, never for operators or brands
- Commercial performance reviews: revenue positioning, OTA mix, yield management gaps, department-level P&L
- Operational governance: owner reporting cadence, KPI frameworks, staff accountability structures
- Current active engagement: Sanskreti The Heritage, Kochi (eco-island heritage resort, Vembanad backwaters)
- Advisory structured around one engagement per destination — full attention, no conflicts

## HOTEL OPERATIONS — GENERAL MANAGER & SENIOR LEADERSHIP

### General Manager

Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Lyfe Hotels & Resorts, Bhubaneswar · 110 rooms

- Led the property to occupancy of up to 85% with healthy ADR, ₹32 crore annual revenue and 42% GOP, with a 300-strong team
- Recognised as Best General Manager in Odisha 2024–25 and Odisha Best Employer 2025
- Named among CMO Asia's Most Influential General Managers 2025
- Awarded IGBC Green Crusader designation, World Earth Day 2025

85% OCC · ₹32 CR REV · 42% GOP · BEST GM ODISHA

## RECOGNITION

- **Best GM in Odisha 2024–25**
  Odisha Tourism & Hospitality Awards
- **Odisha Best Employer 2025**
  Employer recognition
- **CMO Asia Most Influential GMs 2025**
  Industry ranking
- **IGBC Green Crusader 2025**
  World Earth Day designation
- **Taj Award for Empowerment**
  Taj Hotels, 2006–07
- **Fortune Hotels Highest Sales**
  ITC Hotels group, Q2 2019
- **TripAdvisor Certificate of Excellence**
  Keys Hotels Chennai, 2015

## EDUCATION

**Diploma in Hospitality Management**
Institut Hôtelier César Ritz
Switzerland · 2001

**Pre-Opening Internship**
Hilton Geneva
Switzerland · 2000–01

## INDUSTRY ROLES

- **HRACC Member (Govt of India)**
  Representing FHRAI — Hotel Classification Committee
- **Founding Member, SKAL International**
  Trivandrum chapter

### General Manager (Pre-opening)

Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

Ramada Chennai Kattankulathur · Wyndham · 180 rooms

› Pre-opening leadership for a brownfield project (the project was subsequently stopped)

### General Manager

Sep 2022 – Jan 2024

Mercure Chennai Sriperumbudur · Accor · 100 rooms

› Grew revenue from ₹18 crore to ₹24 crore (+33%) at 40% GOP

› Introduced EVs as part of the GOP improvement plan

› Achieved a 100% brand audit score and the highest employee engagement score across Accor properties

₹24 CR REV | 40% GOP | 100% BRAND AUDIT | #1 ENGAGEMENT

### Owner's Representative (Remote)

2021 – 2022

Two hotels (80 and 60 rooms) · Texas, USA

› Owner-side representation for two Texas hotels, delivered remotely from India

### General Manager

Jun 2017 – Jan 2020

Fortune Hotels (ITC Hotels group) · Trivandrum and Vellore · 80 rooms each

› Fortune Vellore (Apr 2019 – Jan 2020): ₹22 crore revenue at 35% GOP; Fortune Hotels award for the highest sales across the brand, Q2 2019

› Fortune Trivandrum (Jun 2017 – Apr 2019): ₹20 crore revenue at 30% GOP; grew rooms and F&B business

### General Manager

Aug 2016 – May 2017

Brunton Boatyard, Kochi · CGH Earth · 30 rooms

› Heritage hotel with UHNI guests; also oversaw David Hall (art gallery and pizzeria) and Chittoor Kottaram

### General Manager · Hotel Manager

Sep 2013 – Jul 2016

Keys Hotels · Trivandrum (100 rooms) and Chennai (30 rooms)

› GM, Keys Trivandrum (Oct 2015 – Jul 2016): ₹18 crore revenue at 35% GOP; grew F&B business significantly

› Hotel Manager, Keys Chennai (Sep 2013 – Oct 2015): ₹9 crore revenue at 32% GOP; Kingfisher recognition for the highest beverage sales; TripAdvisor Certificate of Excellence, 2015

## Front Office Leadership

Jan 2006 – Sep 2013

Taj Kumarakom · Radisson Blu Kuwait · Alila Maldives · Alila Goa

- Front Office Manager, Alila Goa (2011–13) and Alila Maldives (2010): UHNI and HNI guests
- Assistant Front Office Manager, Radisson Blu Kuwait (2007–10): high-security arrangements for US government delegations, with formal commendations
- Assistant Front Office Manager, Taj Kumarakom (2006–07): Taj Award for Empowerment, 2006–07

## Management Trainee to Night Manager

Oct 2001 – Jan 2006

The Leela · Mumbai, Goa and Kovalam

- Management Trainee, The Leela Mumbai (2001–02), promoted to Assistant Manager
- Duty Manager, The Leela Goa (2002–05) and Night Manager, The Leela Kovalam (2005–06): UHNI and international charter guests

### VERITAS ADVISORY APPROACH

- Owner-side only — no operator engagements, no brand affiliations, no referral relationships
- One active engagement per destination — guaranteed full attention
- Deliverables: owner reporting cadence, commercial performance review, KPI benchmarks, governance structure
- Founded on 25 years of seeing the owner's gap from inside hotel operations